



NEVER FORGET

STUDENTS PAY TRIBUTE to a giant portrait of Major Sandeep Unnikrishnan at a Bangalore school on Republic Day. Unnikrishnan, who grew up in Bangalore, was the NSG commando killed during the Mumbai terror attacks of 26/11. He was posthumously awarded the Ashok Chakra, the nation's highest peacetime gallantry award.

SHIMLA | Show Sopper

With the Lok Sabha elections around the corner, Chief Minister Prem Kumar Dhupal is handing out sops to voters. Topping his list of a please-all bonanza is a 10 per cent hike in daily wages of 28,000 workers to be implemented from March 10. State government employees and pensioners have been doled out a 10 per cent interim relief from February 1. Also, Rs 50 crore has been sanctioned to subsidise essential commodities and 15,000 pensioners will be included in the Social Security Pensioners' list. For the urban voters there is a relaxation in the Town and Country Planning Act, 2008, allowing residents to construct two-and-half storey houses 100 m beyond proposed townships on highways without getting their housing plans approved by the authorities. "Himachal has emerged as a role model as over 80 per cent of the poll promises made by my party have been fulfilled," says Dhupal, with a self-congratulatory flourish.

by Ramesh Vinayak



DHUMAL IS DOLING OUT SOPS TO ALL AND SUNDRY BEFORE THE UPCOMING LOK SABHA POLLS.